MONTHLY UPDATE

Djibouti: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-16-2 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *Developments reported in sources published between the beginning of last month and today, grouped by story, oldest first.*

STATUS · PROGRESS · INSTITUTION HOSTING

GOVERNANCE
Strategies, plans and policies · Regional collaboration

FINANCE
New investments

ICT INFRASTRUCTURE
Connectivity

DPI
Data Exchange

TECHNOLOGY
AI

CAPACITY
Training and skills

INCLUSION
Access to services

DATA
Use of satellite data

GEOPOLITICS
US / hyperscaler activities · China activities

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

CADRE D'INTEROPERABILITE DE DJIBOUTI

- **Djibouti – 2026 Government work programme: Omar Guelleh sets out his key priorities** — Africa24 TV, 6 September 2026

  Djibouti's President Ismaïl Omar Guelleh set the government's 2026 priorities at the Council of Ministers on 1 September 2026, including action on cybersecurity and disinformation. He named digitalised procedures, paperless public services and interoperability between administrations as means of modernising the state, listed the digital economy for diversification and announced a national forum on artificial intelligence.

Regional collaboration

DIGITAL COOPERATION ORGANIZATION MEMBERSHIP

- **Djibouti and DCO discuss cooperation on AI and digital transformation** — TechReviewAfrica, 18 September 2026

  Digital Cooperation Organization secretary-general Deemah AlYahya and Djibouti's digital economy minister Safia Mohamed Ali Gadileh discussed cooperation on AI, digital skills, innovation and capacity building. Djibouti recently unveiled a National AI Strategy for 2026–2030. No agreement, funding or timetable is reported.

Finance

New investments

PRIVATE INVESTMENT PIPELINE IDENTIFIED BY DIAGNOSTIC

- **Djibouti Country Private Sector Diagnostic** — International Finance Corporation, 13 September 2026

  The International Finance Corporation published a Country Private Sector Diagnostic for Djibouti in September 2026, prepared with the World Bank Group. It names off-grid solar energy, data centres and tourism as the three subsectors where private investment could grow, and identifies energy reform as a priority. It also notes state-owned enterprises' control of key sectors including telecommunications.

- **World Bank Group Report Identifies Significant Private Investment Potential for Djibouti** — World Bank Group, 14 September 2026

  The World Bank Group's private sector diagnostic for Djibouti, released on 13 September 2026, identifies reforms that could unlock at least $600 million of private investment and about 12,000 jobs over five years in off-grid solar, data centres and tourism. Data centres could draw $160 million to $240 million; existing capacity, served by eight submarine cables, is nearly full.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

HORIZON TERRESTRIAL FIBRE CORRIDOR

- **Projet de fibre optique « Horizon » : Une nouvelle autoroute numérique pour la Corne de l'Afrique** — La Nation, 9 September 2026 ETHIOPIA SUDAN

  Djibouti Telecom, Ethio telecom and Sudatel presented their Horizon terrestrial fibre project to Google, Meta, Microsoft, Amazon and other carriers and vendors in Addis Ababa on 7 September 2026. The multi-terabit link would connect cable landing stations in Djibouti and Port Sudan through Ethiopia, reducing reliance on Red Sea submarine cables. No cost or launch date is given.

DPI

Data Exchange

ELECTRONIC SINGLE WINDOW FOR TRADE

- **Djibouti Plans Electronic Single-window to Streamline Trade** — Dawan Africa, 2 September 2026

  Djibouti's customs administration plans an electronic single window bringing customs and trade procedures onto one platform, discussed at a preparatory workshop at the People's Palace on 1 September 2026. It is working with the commerce ministry, the AfCFTA Secretariat and Korea's CUPIA, and says the system will go beyond the SYDONIAWORLD system now in use. No cost or timetable is given.

Technology

AI

FIRST NATIONAL ARTIFICIAL-INTELLIGENCE STRATEGY

- **Premier Forum national sur l'intelligence artificielle : Djibouti prend le virage de la révolution technologique** — La Nation (Djibouti), 2 September 2026

  Djibouti opened its first national forum on artificial intelligence at the Palais du Peuple on 2 and 3 September, organised by the ministry for the digital economy and innovation under the president's patronage. The framing is explicitly sovereignty: AI as a lever of independence, innovation and development rather than a technology to be received. The forum sits against Vision Djibouti 2035 and UNESCO's readiness assessment.

- **Somali must have a place in artificial intelligence, Djibouti minister tells first national forum** — Somali National News Agency (SONNA), 3 September 2026

  Djibouti's Minister Delegate for the Digital Economy, Safiyo Mohamed Ali, told the country's first national forum on artificial intelligence, opened by President Ismail Omar Guelleh, that Somali, Afar and Arabic must be represented in AI systems or their speakers will be excluded. Finance Minister Ilyas Moussa Dawaleh said 12 submarine cables land in Djibouti, with three more in progress.

- **Djibouti se dote d'une stratégie d'IA sur fond de préparation encore limitée** — wearetech.africa, 4 September 2026

  Djibouti presented the main lines of its first national artificial-intelligence strategy, covering 2026 to 2030 around six priorities: data and AI governance, cybersecurity, training, research, innovation and inclusion. A UNESCO-supported readiness assessment presented alongside it classes the country as emerging, with an ICT development index of 61.6 against AI readiness of about 24.5 out of 100 and no legislation dedicated to artificial intelligence beyond the data-protection provisions of the digital code.

- **Intelligence artificielle : Djibouti lance sa premiere strategie nationale** — L'Observateur, 8 September 2026

  Djibouti presented its first national artificial intelligence strategy for 2026–2030, built on six areas: data and AI governance, cybersecurity, training, research, innovation and inclusion. A readiness assessment carried out with UNESCO rates the country 'emerging', at about 24.5 out of 100, against an ICT development index of 61.6. No budget is given.

FIRST NATIONAL ARTIFICIAL-INTELLIGENCE FORUM

- **Intelligence artificielle : les acteurs d'un écosystème en construction** — La Nation, 3 September 2026

  Djibouti's daily La Nation profiled participants at the country's first national forum on artificial intelligence. They include HOOM, a Djiboutian learning app used by more than 4,500 final-year secondary pupils (about 57% of the cohort), the chatbot Bouho AI, which works in Somali, Afar and Arabic, the EU-funded École 42 Djibouti, and Djibouti Telecom, which sponsored the forum.

- **Somali must have a place in artificial intelligence, Djibouti minister tells first national forum** — Somali National News Agency (SONNA), 3 September 2026

  Summarised under AI.

- **Premier Concours national de prototypage : Quand l'intelligence artificielle révèle les talents de la jeunesse djiboutienne** — La Nation, 7 September 2026

Djibouti's ministry for the digital economy ran the country's first national AI prototyping competition ahead of its first National Forum on Artificial Intelligence. Of 126 applications, 56 were eligible and 17 reached the pitch stage; the winner, Tech Genius, received 2,000,000 Djibouti francs, with 1,000,000 and 500,000 francs for second and third place.

NATIONAL AI READINESS INDEX

- **Djibouti Telecom forme 35 ingénieurs à l'intelligence artificielle** — Agence Djiboutienne d'Information (ADI), 17 September 2026

  Djibouti's state operator certified 35 of its engineers in artificial intelligence at a ceremony presided over by the communications minister, who cited the national AI readiness assessment run on UNESCO's methodology: it credits engaged digital transformation, strategic infrastructure and a nascent academic base while finding room to improve on skills, governance and research. He called for closer ties between the operator, the university and research centres.

Capacity

Training and skills

TECHKID CODING AND ROBOTICS PROGRAMME

- **Clôture de TechKid 2026 : Une nouvelle génération de TechLeaders à Djibouti** — La Nation, 10 September 2026

  The first cohort of Djibouti's TechKid programme completed seven weeks of coding, robotics and artificial intelligence at the national technology and innovation centre. Ten children aged 9 to 16 presented their work to parents, mentors and trainers.

D-CLIC DIGITAL-SKILLS TRAINING PROGRAMME

- **Djibouti et l'OIF ciblent les métiers de la cybersécurité pour insérer la jeunesse** — wearetech.africa, 7 October 2026

  The Francophonie organisation and Djibouti's education and vocational training ministry signed an agreement to train 200 young people in web and mobile development and in network infrastructure and cybersecurity. It extends a programme that the organisation says has trained 200 since 2022.

Inclusion

Access to services

WOMEN TRADERS PROGRAMME ON THE DJIBOUTI CORRIDOR

- **From export readiness to market access: EU-backed support strengthens women's participation in trade along the Djibouti-Ethiopia Corridor** — Horn Economic Review, 3 September 2026 ETHIOPIA

  Forty Ethiopian women traders and exporters attended an export-readiness workshop in Bishoftu on 30-31 July 2026 under the €32 million Djibouti Corridor programme, financed by the EU through Global Gateway, delegated to the Agence Française de Développement and run by TradeMark Africa. The programme also funds digital trade systems such as electronic phytosanitary certification.

Data

Use of satellite data

HYDROSAT NATIONAL SATELLITE PROGRAMME

- **Djibouti à la conquête de l'espace : un pari sur la science, la souveraineté et l'avenir** — La Nation, 10 September 2026

  State media traces Djibouti's space programme since its launch in 2020 as the head of state attends the first international space summit in Paris. It records the training of the country's first specialists and the design and orbiting of two nanosatellites among the steps taken.

- **Le Président Guelleh au Sommet international sur l'Espace : Djibouti défend une ambition spatiale au service du développement** — La Nation, 10 September 2026

  Djibouti's president took part in the second day of the first International Space Summit in Paris, arguing for a national space ambition serving development. The summit gathered delegations from more than 120 countries, including heads of state and government, institutional leaders, scientists, commercial operators and civil society.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

DIGITAL AND MEDIA COOPERATION WITH THE UNITED STATES

- **Djibouti–États-Unis : un nouvel élan pour la coopération numérique et médiatique** — La Nation, 1 September 2026

  Djibouti's communications minister, Mohamed Abdoulkader Moussa Helem, received the US ambassador, Cynthia Kierscht, on 31 August 2026. They discussed US investment in new technologies and telecommunications, and training for journalists and media staff. No agreement, figure or timetable was announced.

China activities

TALKS WITH HUAWEI ON DIGITAL INFRASTRUCTURE

- **Djibouti échange avec Huawei sur le développement de ses infrastructures numériques** — wearetech.africa, 17 September 2026

  Djibouti discussed the development of its digital infrastructure with Huawei, against its position on the telecommunications routes linking Africa, Asia and the Middle East and its stated ambition to become a regional digital hub. No agreement or project has been published.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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